Claude Court: Case #002, CampusPulse

An honest stress-test of CampusPulse (Smart Campus Analytics & Student Success OS), run with the Claude Court prompt structure: Clerk, Prosecutor, Defence, 12 Jurors, Judge.

1. Clerk

The idea in one sentence: CampusPulse is an explainable, rule-based student-risk and success platform for colleges. It merges attendance, marks, LMS, placement and engagement data into one score, gives advisors a ranked "who needs help today" list, and gives deans and IQAC teams accreditation (NAAC/NBA) reporting. Students get a career cockpit on top. [ASSUMPTION: the buyer is the institution, charged per student per year as SaaS.]

What's missing:

- Who pays, and how much. No pricing or buyer is named.
- Whether any real college has run it on live data, or whether it has been tested only on synthetic or sample data.
- How data gets in. Is it CSV upload, ERP/LMS integration, or manual entry? "Breaks down silos" depends entirely on this.
- Why the weights and thresholds are what they are. Where did 57% attendance and 4.7 CGPA come from?

2. Prosecutor

The case against:

- **Market and alternatives:** Campus ERPs, LMS analytics (Moodle, Canvas plugins) and accreditation-software vendors already sell dashboards and attendance alerts. The real competitor is "do nothing": a HOD with a spreadsheet and a phone call. Colleges have lived with that for decades.
- **Willingness to pay:** Indian colleges buy slowly, buy through committees, and often pay little for software. Your buyer (dean/IQAC) and your daily user (faculty) are different people, and faculty already resist extra data entry.
- **Distribution:** There is no stated sales channel. Selling to institutions takes demos, trust, pilots and procurement cycles measured in months.

- **Execution risk:** The feature list is enormous: scoring engine, ML dropout models, fairness audit, mock interviewer, AI mentor, coding lab in four languages, NAAC forecasting, DVV evidence packages. That is several products, and each needs real integrations and real support.
- **Positioning tension:** You sell "deterministic, no black box" but also ship ML dropout prediction and an AI mentor. A skeptical buyer will ask which one it actually is.
- **Timing and compliance:** You will handle sensitive student data, so India's DPDP Act 2023 applies. Labeling a student "at risk" also has real consequences if it is wrong.

Top 3 weaknesses most likely to kill it, ranked:

1. **Data integration.** Without easy ingestion from the ERP/LMS systems colleges already run, the "single view" never gets populated and the product is empty.
2. **No proven buyer or price.** Impressive features don't help if no institution has committed to paying.
3. **Scope sprawl.** Too many features dilute the one thing that could win: explainable early-warning plus an intervention workflow.

3. Defence

The strongest honest case for:

- **First user:** A faculty advisor or HOD in a mid-sized engineering college with 60 to 120 students per advisor. They find out a student is failing only after the internal exam results, when it is too late.
- **Painful moment:** Mid-semester, when attendance and internal marks are sliding but nobody has time to cross-check systems. "Which five students do I call this week, and why?" is a real question.
- **Why now:** NAAC/NBA pressure is pushing institutions to show evidence of student support and outcomes. Faculty and accreditors are also openly wary of black-box AI, and your explainable approach answers that directly.
- **Wedge:** The circuit-breaker rules plus the `/explain` attribution are genuinely differentiated. A rule a dean can read and defend is easier to adopt than an ML score nobody can justify. The intervention log also produces accreditation evidence as a by-product.

3 strongest reasons it could work, ranked:

1. Explainability is a real adoption advantage with faculty and accreditors.

2. The triage list plus the 1-click intervention log creates a repeatable weekly habit.
3. Accreditation reporting gives deans a budget-justifying reason to buy.

4. Jury

#	Juror	Vote	Reason	Question they need answered
1	Target user (advisor)	FIX	Useful list, but I won't re-enter data by hand	How does my data get in automatically?
2	Power user (student)	BUILD	The What-If simulator and mentor are engaging	Will my college actually adopt it?
3	Skeptical user (faculty)	FIX	Worried about being judged by a score	Who sees these flags, and can they hurt a student?
4	Investor	FIX	Too broad, no traction evidence	How many paying institutions in 12 months?
5	Competitor	KILL	ERP vendors can ship this as a module	What can't an incumbent copy in 6 months?
6	Marketer at something similar	FIX	Message is feature-heavy, outcome-light	What's the one measurable result you promise?
7	Engineer	BUILD	Clean architecture, tested, fast	How do you handle messy real-world data?
8	Designer	BUILD	Clear role-based flows	Does a busy faculty member finish the workflow in under a minute?
9	Pricing expert	FIX	No price anchor	Per student, per seat or per institution?
10	Legal / compliance	FIX	Sensitive student data	Where is consent, retention and access logging?
11	A founder who failed	KILL	Selling to colleges drains runway	Can you survive a 9-month sales cycle?

#	Juror	Vote	Reason	Question they need answered
12	Customer support lead	FIX	Every college has different data formats	Who handles onboarding for each one?

Vote count: 7 FIX, 3 BUILD, 2 KILL.

5. Judge

Verdict: FIX.

The 3 reasons

1. The core idea (explainable early-warning plus a triage and intervention workflow) is sound and differentiated. The problem is everything stacked around it.
2. Nothing in the description proves demand. No buyer, price or live-data pilot is mentioned, and the engineering metrics (15ms latency, 80 tests) don't answer the buyer's question.
3. The data-integration and sales path is unsolved, and that is where products like this usually die.

Single biggest risk

Faculty and institutions don't adopt it because loading data is painful and no one has committed to pay.

The exact change to make

- Narrow the pitch to one product: **explainable early-warning and intervention tracking for advisors**, with accreditation evidence as the output.
- Pause the coding lab, mock interviewer and the broader student cockpit until the core has paying users.
- Decide on ML: either keep the product fully deterministic, or position ML as an optional, audited add-on. Don't claim both.
- Justify or let colleges configure the thresholds (57% attendance, 4.7 CGPA). Many institutions use a 75% attendance rule, so a 57% trigger may fire too late.

- Make CSV/Excel upload the first integration path, since that is what colleges can actually do today.
- Remove or soften "NAAC A++ forecasting" unless you can show how it is validated.

What evidence would change the verdict

- **To BUILD:** a college using it on real data and saying it caught students their existing process missed.
- **To KILL:** three or more colleges saying they would not use or pay for it even with free setup.

The 7-day test

- **Build/do:** Take one department's anonymized data export (attendance, internal marks, LMS if available) and run the engine. Produce a one-page top-20 list with `/explain` reasons for each student.
- **Show it to:** 8 faculty or HODs across 2 to 3 colleges. Don't demo features. Hand them the list and ask them to react.
- **Continue number:** At least 5 of 8 say the list matches or improves what they'd flag on their own, **and** at least 1 institution agrees to a pilot (ideally with a price or LOI discussion).
- **Stop number:** Fewer than 3 of 8 find the list useful, or no institution will commit to a pilot even free. Then rethink the buyer and the problem before writing more code.

Court adjourned.